

Exam 3P

Course Title: **Inglés X**
Term: **26-2**
Instructor: **Marron**
Exam Date: **17 April 2025**

General Instructions: Print your name in the upper right-hand corner of this paper. Read each item carefully. Be sure that you understand exactly what is being asked of you.

Do not look at other student's exams. If you have a question or a request during the exam, raise your hand and the instructor will call on you. When you are finished, bring your completed exam to the instructor.

This is an **open book exam**. You may use internet resources to help frame your responses.

Attempt to answer all questions, even if you are uncertain. Tasks will be evaluated by sub-tasks. Three (3) points are available for each sub-task: Accuracy (1 pt), Completeness (1 pt), and Sufficiency (1 pt). Points will be awarded in 0.1 increments. Answer in English unless requested to do so otherwise.

Task 1 (6 pts)

We have taken a very rapid and cursory look at the evolution of modern American humor through the lens of classic American and British comedians. The skits and excerpts we watched nearly all tended to satire or farce, with a hefty dose of slapstick, even though there are many more stylistic elements available to the art of performance humor. Answer the following questions:

1. Charlie Chaplin's silent films helped people laugh during hard times. For example, his film, *Modern Times* used satire and slapstick to highlight the dark realities of modern industrialization. Why is humor an antidote for misery? Or is it?
2. Many of the skits by Monty Python and Saturday Night Live inject zany characters or situations into an otherwise "normal" world. In these skits some actors must play it straight while others "go off the deep end." Why is watching outlandish and silly behavior in the face of the status quo enjoyable? Or is it?

Task 2 (6 pts)

Chinese culture is steeped in Taoism. At the source of Taoism are the writings of the legendary Lao Tzu as compiled in the text, *Tao Te Ching*. Although we read only the first few chapters of the *Tao Te Ching*, what struck you as significant in these passages?

Task 3 (3pts)

Brave New World by Aldous Huxley is a blueprint for one type of possible future for humanity. While generally classified as dystopian, there are certainly utopian elements to be found in this novel, such as environmental stewardship and a stable population (the society vehemently recycles and ecosystem collapse is not an issue; Nature is doing alright.) There may be other benefits as well depending, of course, on one's personal predilections and tastes (unfettered access to drugs and sex, for example).

From the list of topics below select one topic and if possible, comment on both the dystopian aspects of the topic as well as the utopian aspects of the topic. You may decide, however, that the topic can be seen in only one way.

1. Asceticism vs. managed pleasure: John's embrace of hardship asserts value in constraints and striving, framing meaning as earned rather than dispensed.
2. Censorship of science: The Controller's admission that inquiry is curtailed reveals stability's dependence on strategic ignorance.
3. Islands as heterotopias: Exile communities function as pressure valves, preserving dissent in quarantine to protect the core.
4. Managed dying: The hospital's cheerful efficiency eradicates mourning, reducing death to a hygienic endpoint in a service pipeline
5. Eros vs. conditioning: Lenina's scripted sexuality collides with John's ethics of commitment, dramatizing incommensurable erotic grammars
6. Addiction as policy: Linda's perpetual soma-holiday exemplifies institutionalized escapism that substitutes anesthesia for care.
7. Spectacle justice: Public humiliation replaces due process, making governance a theater of shame that disciplines through collective voyeurism.
8. Conformity enforced by exile: Administrative threats expose the soft authoritarianism underpinning "happiness," where deviance is exported rather than debated.
9. Ritualized pseudo-spirituality: The Solidarity Service commodifies transcendence into synchronized intoxication, simulating community while neutralizing individuality.
10. Aesthetic anesthesia: Synthetic entertainments domesticate the sublime, replacing difficult feeling with orchestrated euphoria
11. Ritualized pseudo-spirituality: The Solidarity Service commodifies transcendence into synchronized intoxication, simulating community while neutralizing individuality.
12. *Soma* and flight from authenticity: The chemical shortcut to contentment functions as a prophylactic against self-knowledge and sustained reflection.
13. Sex as social glue: Promiscuity is normalized as a civic duty, transforming eros into a regulatory mechanism that dissipates private loyalties.
14. Infantilization as policy: Moral education stabilizes society by arresting moral development, keeping citizens in a perpetual, cheerful immaturity.
15. Technocratic biopolitics: The state exerts control at the level of life itself—gametogenesis, gestation, and psychological "predestination"—revealing a society where political power is exercised through biological design rather than law or tradition.